

Profile

Personal Information

Name	Gariy, Samuel <i>Otieno</i>
Preferred Name	Gariy
Sex, Birthdate	Male, 10/12/1999

Contact Details

Email, Phone	samuelgariy@gmail.com, +254.711607321, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent Address	Equity Group Foundation 8th Floor Equity Centre, P.O. Box 75104 -00200 Nairobi, Nairobi, 00200, KEN

Demographics

Religion	Other - Christian Christian Baptist
Military Status	None
Hispanic or Latino	No
Race	Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English	First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili	Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Other, Luo	Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status	Other (Non-US)
Birthplace	Nairobi, Kenya (0 Years US, 19 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships	Kenya
Current US Visa	None
Intended US Visa	F-1 Student

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested	Yes, Signed: SAMUEL OTIENO GARIY I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor, financial aid officer, or community leader
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Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name	Dr. Zachary A Gariy
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	+254.722883077, Mobile
Address	the same as my home address
Occupation	College teacher, Employed, Lecturer, Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology, Juja, Kiambu, KEN
Education	Graduate school Bachelors (1987), Masters (1989), University of Nairobi, Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN Doctorate (1999), Ruhr- University of Bochum, Bochum, Bochum, DEU

Parent 2

Mother

Name	Mrs. Rose A Ondiek
Birthplace	Kenya
Email, Phone	+254.722390035, Mobile
Address	the same as my home address
Occupation	Teacher or administrator (secondary), Employed, Teacher, Teacher Service Commission
Education	Graduated from college/university Bachelors (1991), Kenyatta University, Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN Masters (1998), University of Kassel, DEU

Siblings

1. Paul O Gariy, Age 17, Brother, Some high/secondary school
2. Christie A Gariy, Age 13, Sister, Some grade/primary school
3. Judy A Gariy, Age 8, Sister, Some grade/primary school

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

Alliance High School, Kikuyu, KEN, Public, CEEB: 619330 (02/2014 - 11/2017)

Counselor Ms. Gladys A Otido, Teacher
Email, Phone gnanzala2010@gmail.com, +254.722354971
Boarding School Yes: Living at School
Progression Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date 11/2017

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 2 / 374, Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
Mathematics	Mathematics	Mathematics
English	English	English
Physics	Physics	Physics
Chemistry	Chemistry	Chemistry
Biology	Biology	Biology
Kiswahili	Kiswahili	Kiswahili
Geography	Geography	Geography
Computer	Computer	Computer

Honors

World Scholars Cup International Round Bangkok 2016. Silver Medal in Literature and Writing	International	11
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26th rank out of 615,772 candidates who sat for the KCSE National Examination.	National	12
Kenya National Mathematics Olympiad Silver Medal. Position 5 Nationally	National	11
Loreto National Science and Mathematics Olympiad (Best Team in Physics)	National	12
Science and Engineering Fair. Best in the IT category.	State/Regional	12

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	Equity Group Foundation
Counselor	Ms. Eva Muriuki
Email, Phone	eva.muriuki@equitybank.co.ke, +254.763026098

Future Plans

Engineer, Doctorate

Testing

SAT (March 2016 or after)

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	700	10/06/2018
Math	710	10/06/2018
Essay	18	10/06/2018
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	Yes	

SAT Subject Tests

Math Level 2	730	11/2018
Physics	690	11/2018
Math Level 1	700	11/2018

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
English	A-	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	A-	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Biology	B	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Geography	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE
Computer Studies	A	11/2017, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Science/Math

9, 10, 11, 12	Treasurer, Math Club.
School	I managed the club's resources: acquisition of books and finances, organized the budget for all the School's first Math contest in 2017.
5 hr/wk, 32 wk/yr	
Continue	

Student Govt./Politics

9, 10, 11, 12	Form Representative(2014-2016), Academics Captain
School	Represented students in the school academics board and was involved in policy making to improve students academic life. Best captain in second term
6 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	
Continue	

Career Oriented

11, 12	Chairman, Career Committee
School	Organizing college expos, sessions with university admission officers. Helped 10th grader get into Choate Rosemary Hall in Connecticut, USA.
1.5 hr/wk, 25 wk/yr	
Continue	

Religious

9, 10, 11, 12, PG	Kahawa Baptist Church Youth Activities Coordinator
Break, Year	During holidays taught sunday school classes. After high school organised activities for local youth and street children like basketball tournaments.
8 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr	
Continue	

Athletics: Club

9, 10, 11, 12	Soccer, Activities Coordinator, Small Premier league club
School	Organised training sessions, in charge of acquisition of playing equipment. Winners in School Inter-club soccer tournament 2017 & 2018.
10 hr/wk, 33 wk/yr	
Continue	

Other Club/Activity

11, 12	Scouts Association Activities Coordinator
School	Organised Scout hikes, camps, tree planting and community volunteer activities such as children home visits. Best Scout Troop Kiambu County 2017,2018
8 hr/wk, 32 wk/yr	
Continue	

Music: Vocal

11, 12	Chairman, Poetry Club
School	Organised termly school poetry challenges, managed the choral verse teams that represented the school in the National Music Festival where they excel.
6 hr/wk, 25 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11, 12	Activities Coordinator Social Welfare Society
School	Organised visits to Homes for the elderly in Thogoto and hospital visits in Kikuyu Hospital
10 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	
Continue	

Religious

PG	Technical Sound Director , Kahawa Sukari Baptist
Year	Setting up the sound system, operating the sound mixer during services, maintaining the speakers
10 hr/wk, 44 wk/yr	
Continue	

Work (Paid)

PG	Relationship officer, Equity Bank
Year	Worked in the operations department in mobile banking, reception and Clearing section. Employee of the month 4 times
60 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	

Writing

Personal Essay

Share an essay on any topic of your choice. It can be one you've already written, one that responds to a different prompt, or one of your own design.

"Sam, why did you bring the cake back?" My mother asked me, her face a mixture of disappointment and sympathy.

"I forgot mummy," I lied, struggling to hold back the torrent of tears. My ninth birthday was supposed to be the happiest day of the year but instead, I was crying into my mother's lap. On the table was the chocolate cake she had baked me to take to school to celebrate with my 'non-existent' friends.

A gift, an old copy of the first Sherlock Holmes book: 'A Study in Scarlet' was my saving grace. Ruffling through its pages, I savored its smell. I liked it. Immersed in the book, I instantly identified with the main character - Sherlock Holmes; full of intelligence and yet eccentric in a manner that made him very socially awkward. In my case, I was top of my class yet found it very difficult to connect with my peers.

In those rare occasions where I dared to play with my 'friends', things didn't pan out well. The suburban setting of the outskirts of Nairobi town, where we lived, availed large grassy fields to play. The ball, a polythene bag tied with ropes, flew out of the pitch and I went to fetch it eagerly. On bringing it back, everyone had stopped playing and was looking at me with disdain. "We don't want you here!" Kamau, the captain shouted. It hurt.

Why wasn't I like the rest? I wondered. Most of all, why couldn't I connect with the rest?

I ran to a nearby stream and cried. My tears in sync with the stream's flow; washing away all my frustrations, fears and laments. Why? Why Me? Reading the book, I was sure Sherlock felt the same up in his apartment on Baker Street. I, however, felt disadvantaged; whilst Sherlock had Dr. Watson to help him socially, I had no one. Regardless, I felt hope and in this sense a desire to acquire knowledge and take charge of my life. Probably, my desire for acceptance was holding me back.

I now had a mission and my loneliness paled in comparison to it. I dedicated more energy to reading books rather than worrying about my social standing. My thirst for knowledge became insatiable, I read everything and for every new thing I learned, a piece of my broken heart was restored. For the first time in a long time, I was happy.

I remember my next birthday, October 2009, particularly well. I was in class four then. A literature lesson in particular. We were reading a comprehension of the exploits of Hercules. The comprehension, however, mentioned only three accomplishments and I was ticked off. As silly as it may sound, I shot up and declared that those were but a few of the labors of Hercules, more so the account was distorted. "First of all, Hercules was the son of Zeus, god of thunder...", I then went on to give a 'history lesson' in Greek mythology, my obsession at that moment. The ringing of the bell abruptly brought my story to an end. I was shocked! I was in front of the class and everyone including my teacher was silent. Their eyes the only indication that their ears were yearning for more. I didn't receive a standing ovation but the admiration in their eyes spoke volumes.

The rest of that term was a great experience. I made friends eager to pick my knowledge and through that discovered my natural conversation humor. Even Kamau became my friend. In fact, I helped him in his academics despite being a class lower than him. My first friends -books, words, and knowledge- brought me more friends. At that moment, I realized I was better than Sherlock in that I had more than one Dr. Watson. Everything I thought I needed had been there all along. Being me was enough.

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

December was a month of rest and family time after graduating from high school. In January, I ranked 26th among the 615,772 KCSE candidates, earning an internship position in Equity Bank. After rigorous training, I was dispatched to Ruiru Branch in the suburbs of Kiambu County.

The staff was friendly. Working was sobering in the sense that a mistake had real-life repercussions. For instance, if you were to give a customer excess money after a withdrawal the extra amount would be taken out of your salary. This taught me a sense of responsibility. More so, the versatility and surprisingly huge workload the job demanded stretched me to my limits and showed my resilient side.

I also organized a Basketball outreach Tournament at my church. It was a rousing success as not only did local youth turn up but they also received the word of God. I also took up the position of technical sound director at my church which I relish as it satisfied my need to help out while making use of my natural leaning to tinkering with electronics.

I was involved in motivational talks back at my high school. It felt good giving back to the community that had given so much to me.

In addition, I was able to go camping on the shores of Lake Naivasha, exploring the outside life I enjoy so much. The tranquil environment also doubled up as an inspiration to hone my poetry skills.

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Have you ever been adjudicated guilty or convicted of a misdemeanor or felony?

No

Princeton University Questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2019
Admission plan	Regular Decision
Princeton-specific Fee Waiver	Common App
Financial aid	Yes
Portfolio Slideroom	No
Princeton Alumni Interview Consent	I would like to share my contact information and high school name with Princeton alumni interviewers, for the purpose of contacting me to arrange an alumni interview.

Academics

Which degree would you most likely pursue at Princeton? Your choice is not binding in any way:

BSE Engineering

"This boy spoils everything" These words were and are still always on my parents' mouths. My insatiable curiosity which leads me to open any electronic I come across has been a source of joy and detriment for me over the years. Our little Picasso, my father would call me when I was smaller due to my drawing and painting tendencies. Then when my friends played a prank on me with a shock pen, my view expanded. I pried it open and spent hours staring at its tiny circuit. It was beautiful. Art, a different kind but art all the same. The creativity and design behind it attracted me. This way I fell in love with it.

Years later, our relationship is still strong. Now I can confidently call myself a self-taught electrician. I can install sockets, switches. I even repaired a faulty Xbox controller. Regardless, I am still a novice as was the case when I fried the motherboard of my father's laptop. Most recently, I have started learning about programmable logic controllers (PLCs) and their application in automation of the Kenyan industry which further stimulates my interest.

These aside, I still aspire to learn electrical designs on a large scale that is production and distribution and on a small scale electrical circuits and possibly later for my graduate level on an even smaller scale, nanotechnology. It is at Princeton that I want to explore and gain knowledge as my role model Marie Curie puts it. *Nothing in life is to be feared, it is only to be understood. Now is the time to understand more, so that we may fear less.*

What draws me to Princeton engineering is its vigor and intensity. The academic rigor of interacting with award-winning professors and running my ideas by them captivates me. I'll be able to explore my ideas under the guidance of the best. Princeton with its focus on undergraduates means that alongside the faculty I will be able to conduct research at the undergraduate level. This greatly appeals to me. More so, funding will not be a limiting factor in this case

I intend to join the Department of Electrical Engineering where I will be able to integrate my interests in pursuit of my passions. Particularly, in learning electrical systems and more so programmable logic and controls and their applications to various areas such as material science. The diverse subjects and curriculum of the major offered in

Princeton allow me the possibility of venturing into any field in the future with the solid Princetonian undergraduate education as my foundation. Furthermore, the option of a certificate in a secondary interest means I can also delve a little into my interests such as creative writing.

I, therefore, feel Princeton engineering would be intellectually satisfying and go a long way in helping me achieve my goal: to provide engineering solutions that improve the world.

In which program of study do you think you would like to major at Princeton? Your choice is not binding in any way: Electrical Engineering

In which second program of study do you think you would like to major at Princeton? Your choice is not binding in any way: Civil and Environmental Engineering

In addition to the major you noted above, please indicate which certificate program might interest you: Materials Science and Engineering

In addition to the major you noted above, please indicate which second choice certificate program might interest you: Creative Writing

Self-reported external exams I have not taken and do not have any external exam results to report

Contacts

Previously applied No

Family

Sibling applied No

Family: No

Relative employed at member No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here:
<http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.